

Forms input

The `<form>` tag allows you to create an input form to do things like collect names, email addresses and so on. Everything that appears on the form is enclosed in between form opening and closing tags:

```
<form>
```

your stuff here

```
</form>
```

For example we can create input text boxes to let the user type in their city and state:

```
<form>
```

```
City:<br>
```

```
<input type="text" name="city">
```

```
<br>
```

```
State:<br>
```

```
<input type="text" name="state">
```

```
</form>
```

Other options allow you to add radio buttons and checkboxes. Using radio buttons as an example, to have the user select gender as male or female, we would add the following lines in between the form opening and closing tags:

```
<input type="radio" name="sex" value="male" checked>Male
```

```
<input type="radio" name="sex" value="female">Female
```

Of course you have to provide a means for the user to submit the data. You can add a submit button with this line:

```
<input type="submit" value="Submit">
```

To make something happen when the user clicks the submit button, such as take the info entered above and sticking it into a database, you need to write a script to handle the submit clicked action. The script itself is out of the scope of this tutorial, but lets say it was *myaction.php*. Then we would modify the opening form tag to have the form execute this action when the button is clicked:

```
<form action="myaction.php">
```

CSS for Bi-Colored Web Page

In this simple example we introduce the use of style sheets to change the appearance of your web pages. A common task is formatting the page to display different areas, you might want to display a 2 or 3 column web page or add headers and footers or a sidebar. In this example we show how to set up a simple side bar, distinguished from the main web page by color:

The first thing to do in order to set this up is to put your style sheet in between the head tags. Our very simple style sheet will set the width of the sidebar and its background color. We also set the background color and left margin for the main part of the page:

```
<head>
```

```
<style type="text/css">
```

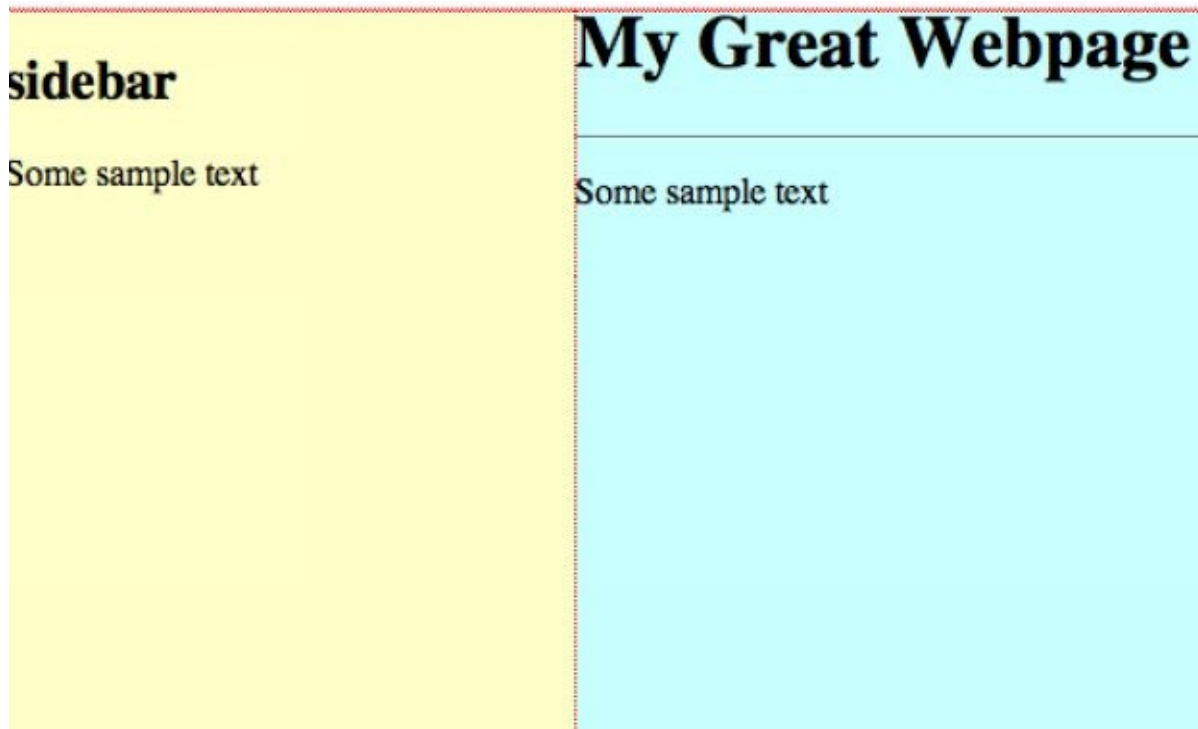
```
html, body {height: 100%; margin: 0}
```

```
#content {width: 100%; height: 100%}
```

```
#left {width: 250px; height: 100%; float: left; background-color: #FFFFCC}
```

```
#right {margin-left: 250px; height: 100%; background-color: #CCFFFF}
```

```
</style>
```



`</head>`

In the body section of the html file we use `<div>` tags to set up each section. There will be a `<div>` for the sidebar and main part of the page. We also need an extra `<div>` within which these are nested. This is shown here:

```
<div id="content">  
</div>
```

In between the opening and closing tags, we put the `<div>` tags for each section. First here is the sidebar. We have to tell the browser what style to use. This is done by setting the id to left:

```
<div id="left">  
<h2>sidebar</h2>  
<p>Some sample text</p>  
</div>
```

We do the same for the main part of the page:

```
<div id="right">
<h1>My Great Webpage</h1>
<hr>
<p>Some sample text</p>
</div>
```

Now of course you can put anything in between the div tags of each section, but we are only showing some text here for some simplicity. The entire code is shown here:

```
<html>
<head>
<style type="text/css">
html, body {height: 100%; margin: 0}
#content {width: 100%; height: 100%}
#left {width: 250px; height: 100%; float: left; background-color: #FFFFCC}
#right {margin-left: 250px; height: 100%; background-color: #CCFFFF}
</style>
</head>
<body>
<div id="content">
<div id="left">
<h2>sidebar</h2>
<p>Some sample text</p>
</div>
<div id="right">
<h1>My Great Webpage</h1>
<hr>
<p>Some sample text</p>
</div>
</div>
</body>
</html>
```